Restore drill: the emergency as an exercise

Recovery from the steel backup · timing + test transaction · Self-Experiment 3

⚠ **Seed words NEVER belong on this sheet.** No words, no partial words, no hints about the order, not even a practice seed. This sheet records only the process, the times and the stumbling blocks, so after the drill it can sit in a folder without any risk. The only value here is the wallet fingerprint, because it is a public check value.

⚠ **Run the first drill before the first real amount.** You practice with the real steel backup, but the wallet holds only a small test amount. Real amounts follow only once all three proofs have been delivered.

PREPARATION (TICK OFF BEFORE YOU START)

- ☐ Steel backup complete: every word stamped, and on capsule systems with numbered discs the numbering checked (the order must still be clear when everything falls apart)
- ☐ A small test amount sits on the wallet, transaction confirmed
- ☐ Expected wallet fingerprint written down: _____ (public check value, gives nothing away)
- ☐ Every other document put away: paper notes, microSD, second backups into another room
- ☐ Clock ready, pen ready, no camera in the room

The scenario: device lost, home burned down, paper gone: **only the steel backup survived.** From the start you work from the steel and nothing else. If you do have to look somewhere else, do not abort: note it as a finding. Finding exactly that gap is the purpose of the drill.

THE DRILL

1. ☐ **Start the clock.** Enter the start time below.
2. ☐ **Reset the device to factory settings.** On a second device this step is skipped. Reset your own device only after a passed fingerprint check and stage two (chapter 6).
3. ☐ **Start the recovery, read the words from the steel only** and type them straight into the device. Note every moment you get stuck right away on the right ("word 17 unclear", "disc turned around"). For passphrase wallets, then enter the passphrase as a separate step, and proofs 1 to 3 apply to the passphrase wallet.
4. ☐ **Proof 1 (fingerprint):** the fingerprint shown _____ matches the expected one ☐ yes ☐ no
5. ☐ **Proof 2 (balance):** the test amount is visible once the wallet has loaded.
6. ☐ **Proof 3 (control):** send the test amount back and wait for the confirmation. Only a successful **spend** proves full control, the balance alone does not.
7. ☐ **Stop the clock.** Enter the end time.

TIME

Start: _____

End: _____

Duration: _____

Date: _____

STUMBLING BLOCKS / FINDINGS (FOR THE LOGBOOK, THE MORE HONEST, THE MORE USEFUL)

_____

_____

_____

_____

RESULT

- ☐ **Passed:** all three proofs delivered (fingerprint, balance, return transaction). The backup is no longer a hope, it is a plan
- ☐ **Not passed:** no failure, but the very reason you practice. Close the gap (correct the backup, change the procedure), then repeat the drill while only the test amount is at stake

Next drill due (after every fundamental change to the setup, no yearly restore): _____

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